and systems. Therefore, blockchain can play a crucial role in implementing decentralized systems by providing software-based intermediation to other (non-currency) peer-to-peer transactions.

Let’s take a look at a blockchain to give you an idea of what transactions, blocks, and chains of blocks look like. This example will help you visualize blockchain context and the problem space discussed in the next sections, which explore the transactions and blocks for the Ethereum public blockchain (https://etherscan.io). Figure 1.2 shows transactions (Tx and transaction#) that represent messages between two accounts (From and To) representing peer participants. These Txs enable the recording of information on the blocks of the blockchain.

